SALIM SAIF SALIM ALQAYDI

Captain • Officer, United Arab Emirates Armed Forces
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PROFILE

Captain in the United Arab Emirates Armed Forces, commissioned from the Royal Military Academy Sandhurst in 2016 and currently serving in the Presidential Guard. Served in Land Forces artillery before specialising in Joint Terminal Attack Control and joint fires. Four operational deployments since 2018, and four years training and qualifying JTAC operators. Holds a bachelor's degree in finance from Abu Dhabi University, completed in service.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- Hudson Horse Merit Award on commissioning from the Royal Military Academy Sandhurst (2016).
- Came first on the UAE's first JTAC Instructor Course, and one of the first qualified JTAC instructors in the force.
- Selected to serve in the Presidential Guard.
- Four operational deployments between 2018 and 2025.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Officer, Presidential Guard (PG) — 2024 – Present

United Arab Emirates Armed Forces

- Commissioned officer in the Presidential Guard, having served four years attached to the formation before transferring.
- Responsible for the UAE Joint Fire Support Executive Steering Committee (JSF ESC).
- Coordinate joint exercises (FALCON STRIKE) and routine allied countries JTAC training with their foreign defence attachés.
- Responsible for introducing new equipment and technology used within the Joint Fires Group 2025 (including abroad Factory Acceptance Tests) .

Lead JTAC Instructor, attached to Presidential Guard — 2020 – 2024

United Arab Emirates Armed Forces

- Lead JTAC instructor, in command of the UAE's JTAC courses from 2020 to 2024, delivering instruction and coordinating all course requirements, including for international students.
- Topped the first JTAC Instructor Course run in the UAE, then trained and qualified the operators who followed.
- Lead JTAC on Desert Flag, the multinational exercise run by the UAE Air Operations Centre.
- Provided Joint Terminal Attack Control to Presidential Guard units on operations and exercises over four years.

Joint Terminal Attack Controller (JTAC) — 2018 – 2020

Land Forces, United Arab Emirates Armed Forces

- Qualified as a JTAC, controlling close air support and coordinating joint fires for Land Forces units.

Artillery Officer — 2017 – 2018

Artillery, Land Forces, United Arab Emirates Armed Forces

- Platoon commander in a UAE Land Forces artillery battalion, responsible for the delivery and coordination of indirect fire support.

EDUCATION & MILITARY TRAINING

GENAI101x: Generative AI 2026
Professional development certificate

Bachelor's Degree in Finance 2023
Abu Dhabi University (ADU)

Royal Military Academy Sandhurst (RMAS) 2016
Officer commissioning. Hudson Horse Merit Award.

Zayed Military College (ZMC) 2015 – 2016
Officer cadet training

National Service 2014 – 2015
United Arab Emirates MOD

Fujairah Private Academy Graduated 2014
Secondary education

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Joint Terminal Attack Control and close air support
- Joint fires planning, artillery and indirect fire
- Instructing and qualifying JTAC operators
- Operational planning and small-unit command
- Languages: Arabic (native), English (fluent)
- English proficiency tests: IELTS 7.5/9, ALCPT 99/100